

Rafaela X. Solís (she/her)

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Game designer pursuing dual B.S. degrees in Game Design and Game Programming with a Project Management minor. Leads design across three studio titles at Pentad Games, prototyping features directly in Unity and Unreal Engine 5 with C++, Lua, and C#, and directing the team that builds them. Placed 2nd internationally in the CurseForge Subnautica 2 Modding Contest, with 6,500+ mod downloads on CurseForge. Programming makes it possible to prototype designs firsthand and work fluently with engineers; production training means leading a team or supporting one.

EDUCATION

Champlain College | Burlington, VT | Expected May 2028

Bachelor of Science in Game Design; Bachelor of Science in Game Programming; Project Management Minor. GPA: 3.90. Dean's List, all semesters.

Relevant Coursework: Level Design, Applied Ludology, Principles of Game Design, Game Technology I and II, Game Studio I, Games Testing Lab, Artificial Intelligence for Games, Game Architecture, Principles of Project Management

EXPERIENCE

Lead Developer (Lead Designer, Lead Programmer, Product Owner) | Pentad Games (formerly Vellum Games) | October 2024 - Present

- Lead design on Open Shift, a co-op cozy-horror storekeeping game entering beta, directing a 5-7 person team (up to 10) and driving community building and teaser launch
- Designed 50+ gameplay features across Open Shift, Scriptorium (Lead Designer), and Mega Market Mayhem (Designer, Engine Implementer), scoping each from concept to a playtested, implementable state

- Prototype designs directly in Unity 6 (C#), delivering weekly playable builds within an Agile/Scrum workflow
- Designed rune-drawing combat, training a CNN model in Python (TensorFlow, Keras) to recognize player-drawn runes and iterating it through playtests
- Run iterative playtests, compile player data, and turn findings into design revisions
- Author GDDs, VDDs, system diagrams, and level design mockups that align art, programming, and audio
- Built the studio's self-hosted production suite in AFFiNE, with kanban tracking, art critique workflows, AI meeting notes, and nightly builds via GitHub Actions

Project Manager | Leahy Center for Digital Forensics & Cybersecurity, Champlain College
| Burlington, VT | Fall 2026 – Present

- Restructure documentation, workflows, and meeting processes across the organization's teams while keeping each team in a familiar working environment

Producer | Champlain College Academic Game Projects | August 2024 – Present

- Produced 5+ multidisciplinary game teams on weekly sprints, facilitating Agile/Scrum ceremonies and keeping projects on schedule
- On The Owl Keeper (educational game), cut full voice-acted dialogue to meet the deadline and redirected the sound designer to voice key story moments, preserving narrative impact

Food Handler (FOH/BOH) | Bakery Lorraine | San Antonio, TX | August 2022 – May 2023

- Stepped into team lead during peak hours in a high-volume kitchen, coordinating prep and preventing stock shortages

PROJECTS

Subnautica 2 Modding Contest: 2nd Place Internationally | CurseForge | June 2026

- Designed and built Easy Third Person, a third-person camera mod in C++ and Lua for Unreal Engine 5, winning 2nd place internationally and \$650
- Reverse-engineered UE4SS to implement custom systems; featured on CurseForge's main page banner for multiple weeks
- Released Easy Third Person and The Gold Mod with 6,000+ combined downloads, plus 3 Minecraft modpacks with 560+ downloads

Indie Game Development | solunabeeboo.itch.io | March 2020 – Present

- Designed and developed 12+ original games solo, owning concept, systems design, art, build, and release
- Created all original art, including hand-drawn sprites, 3D models, and textures

SKILLS

Languages: C++, Lua, C#, Python, Java, HTML/CSS

Design: Systems Design, Gameplay Design, Level Design, Technical Design, Narrative Design, Rapid Prototyping, Playtesting and Data Analysis, GDDs, VDDs, System Diagrams, UI/UX

Engines and Tools: Unreal Engine 5 (Lyra Framework), UEFN, Unity 6, UE4SS, Blueprints, Shaders, OpenGL, Git, GitHub Actions, Subversion

Production: Agile/Scrum, Jira, Confluence, Taiga, AFFiNE, Production Documentation

Art: Pixel Art, 3D Modeling, Blender, Aseprite, Photoshop, Illustrator, DaVinci Resolve

Playtesting: External playtests for Behaviour Interactive (Dead by Daylight, Blight: Survival)